



General Assembly

February Session, 2026

Raised Bill No. 230

LCO No. 1365



Referred to Committee on GENERAL LAW

Introduced by:
(GL)

***AN ACT CONCERNING THE DEPARTMENT OF CONSUMER
PROTECTION'S RECOMMENDATIONS REGARDING LIQUOR
CONTROL.***

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Assembly convened:

1 Section 1. Subsection (b) of section 30-18 of the 2026 supplement to
2 the general statutes is repealed and the following is substituted in lieu
3 thereof (*Effective from passage*):

4 (b) Subject to the provisions of this subsection, an out-of-state
5 shipper's permit for alcoholic liquor other than beer shall allow the sale
6 and delivery or shipment of wine manufactured by the permittee on the
7 permitted premises directly to a consumer in this state. Such permittee,
8 when selling and shipping wine directly to a consumer in this state,
9 shall: (1) Ensure that the shipping labels on all containers of wine
10 shipped directly to a consumer in this state conspicuously state the
11 following: "CONTAINS ALCOHOL—SIGNATURE OF A PERSON
12 AGE 21 OR OLDER REQUIRED FOR DELIVERY"; (2) obtain the
13 signature of a person age twenty-one or older at the address prior to
14 delivery, after requiring the signer to demonstrate that he or she is age
15 twenty-one or older by providing a valid motor vehicle operator's
16 license or a valid identity card described in section 1-1h; (3) not ship

17 more than five gallons of wine in any two-month period to any person
 18 in this state and not ship any wine until such permittee is registered,
 19 with respect to the permittee's sales of wine to consumers in this state,
 20 for purposes of the taxes imposed under chapters 219 and 220, with the
 21 Department of Revenue Services; (4) pay, to the Department of Revenue
 22 Services, all sales taxes and alcoholic beverage taxes due under chapters
 23 219 and 220 on sales of wine to consumers in this state, and file, with
 24 said department, all sales tax returns and alcoholic beverage tax returns
 25 relating to such sales, with the amount of such taxes to be calculated as
 26 if the sale were in this state at the location where delivery is made; (5)
 27 [report to the Department of Consumer Protection a separate and
 28 complete record of all sales and shipments to consumers in the state, on
 29 a ledger sheet or similar form which readily presents a chronological
 30 account of such permittee's dealings with each such consumer; (6)]
 31 permit the Department of Consumer Protection and Department of
 32 Revenue Services, separately or jointly, to perform an audit of the
 33 permittee's records upon request; [(7)] (6) not ship to any address in the
 34 state where the sale of alcoholic liquor is prohibited by local option
 35 pursuant to section 30-9; [(8)] (7) hold an in-state transporter permit
 36 under section 30-19f or make any such shipment through the use of a
 37 person who holds such an in-state transporter permit; and [(9)] (8)
 38 execute a written consent to the jurisdiction of this state, its agencies and
 39 instrumentalities and the courts of this state concerning the enforcement
 40 of this section and any related laws, rules, or regulations, including, but
 41 not limited to, tax laws, rules or regulations.

42 Sec. 2. Section 30-18a of the 2026 supplement to the general statutes
 43 is repealed and the following is substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective from*
 44 *passage*):

45 (a) As used in this section:

46 (1) "Out-of-state" (A) means (i) any state other than Connecticut, (ii)
 47 any territory or possession of the United States, (iii) the District of
 48 Columbia, or (iv) the Commonwealth of Puerto Rico, and (B) does not

49 include any foreign country;

50 (2) "Retailer" means any business entity that (A) is primarily engaged
 51 in selling alcoholic liquor in sealed bottles or other containers for off-
 52 premises consumption, and (B) holds a retailer permit issued by the
 53 alcohol beverage authority of its home state; and

54 (3) "Wine" includes, but is not limited to, (A) cider not exceeding six
 55 per cent alcohol by volume, and (B) apple wine not exceeding fifteen per
 56 cent alcohol by volume.

57 ~~[(a)]~~ (b) (1) An out-of-state winery shipper's permit for wine shall
 58 allow the sale of wine to manufacturer and wholesaler permittees in this
 59 state as permitted by law and for those shippers that produce not more
 60 than one hundred thousand gallons of wine per year, the sale and
 61 shipment by the holder thereof to a retailer of wine manufactured by
 62 such permittee in the original sealed containers of not more than fifteen
 63 gallons per container. [For purposes of this section, "wine" shall include
 64 cider not exceeding six per cent alcohol by volume and apple wine not
 65 exceeding fifteen per cent alcohol by volume.]

66 (2) An out-of-state retailer shipper's permit for wine shall allow the
 67 sale and shipment of wine directly to a consumer in this state.

68 ~~[(b)]~~ (c) Subject to the provisions of this subsection, the permits under
 69 subsection ~~[(a)]~~ (b) of this section shall allow the sale and delivery or
 70 shipment of wine manufactured or sold by the permittee directly to a
 71 consumer in this state. Such permittee, when selling and shipping wine
 72 directly to a consumer in this state, shall: (1) Ensure that the shipping
 73 labels on all containers of wine shipped directly to a consumer in this
 74 state conspicuously state the following: "CONTAINS ALCOHOL –
 75 SIGNATURE OF A PERSON AGE 21 OR OLDER REQUIRED FOR
 76 DELIVERY"; (2) obtain the signature of a person age twenty-one or older
 77 at the address prior to delivery, after requiring the signer to demonstrate
 78 that he or she is age twenty-one or older by providing a valid motor
 79 vehicle operator's license or a valid identity card described in section 1-

80 1h; (3) not ship more than five gallons of wine in any two-month period
 81 to any person in this state and not ship any wine until such permittee is
 82 registered, with respect to the permittee's sales of wine to consumers in
 83 this state, for purposes of the taxes imposed under chapters 219 and 220,
 84 with the Department of Revenue Services; (4) pay, to the Department of
 85 Revenue Services, all sales taxes and alcoholic beverage taxes due under
 86 chapters 219 and 220 on sales of wine to consumers in this state, and file,
 87 with said department, all sales tax returns and alcoholic beverage tax
 88 returns relating to such sales, with the amount of such taxes to be
 89 calculated as if the sale were in this state at the location where delivery
 90 is made; (5) [report to the Department of Consumer Protection a
 91 separate and complete record of all sales and shipments to consumers
 92 in the state, on a ledger sheet or similar form which readily presents a
 93 chronological account of such permittee's dealings with each such
 94 consumer; (6)] permit the Department of Consumer Protection and
 95 Department of Revenue Services, separately or jointly, to perform an
 96 audit of the permittee's records upon request; [(7)] (6) not ship to any
 97 address in the state where the sale of alcoholic liquor is prohibited by
 98 local option pursuant to section 30-9; [(8)] (7) hold an in-state transporter
 99 permit under section 30-19f or make any such shipment through the use
 100 of a person who holds such an in-state transporter permit; [(9)] (8)
 101 execute a written consent to the jurisdiction of this state, its agencies and
 102 instrumentalities and the courts of this state concerning the enforcement
 103 of this section and any related laws, rules, or regulations, including tax
 104 laws, rules or regulations; and [(10)] (9) comply with the provisions of
 105 section 30-68m regarding the prohibition of selling wine below cost.

106 [(c)] (d) The Department of Consumer Protection, in consultation
 107 with the Department of Revenue Services, may adopt regulations in
 108 accordance with the provisions of chapter 54 to assure compliance with
 109 the provisions of subsection [(b)] (c) of this section.

110 [(d)] (e) A holder of a permit under subsection [(a)] (b) of this section,
 111 when advertising or offering wine for direct shipment to a consumer in
 112 this state via the Internet or any other on-line computer network, shall

113 clearly and conspicuously state such liquor permit number in its
114 advertising.

115 ~~[(e)]~~ (f) (1) For purposes of chapter 219, the holder of a permit under
116 subsection ~~[(a)]~~ (b) of this section, when shipping wine directly to a
117 consumer in this state, shall be deemed to be a retailer engaged in
118 business in this state as defined in chapter 219 and shall be required to
119 be issued a seller's permit pursuant to chapter 219.

120 (2) For purposes of chapter 220, the holder of a permit under
121 subsection ~~[(a)]~~ (b) of this section, when shipping wine directly to a
122 consumer in this state, shall be deemed to be a distributor as defined in
123 chapter 220 and shall be required to be licensed pursuant to chapter 220.

124 ~~[(f)]~~ (g) Any person who applies for an out-of-state winery shipper's
125 permit for wine or for the renewal of such permit shall furnish an
126 affidavit to the Department of Consumer Protection, in such form as
127 may be prescribed by the department, affirming whether the out-of-
128 state winery that is the subject of such permit produced more than one
129 hundred thousand gallons of wine during the most recently completed
130 calendar year.

131 ~~[(g)]~~ (h) The annual fee for an out-of-state winery shipper's permit for
132 wine shall be three hundred fifteen dollars and the annual fee for an out-
133 of-state retailer shipper's permit for wine shall be six hundred dollars.

134 ~~[(h)]~~ As used in this section, "out-of-state" means any state other than
135 Connecticut, any territory or possession of the United States, the District
136 of Columbia or the Commonwealth of Puerto Rico, but does not include
137 any foreign country.]

138 Sec. 3. Subsection (b) of section 30-37f of the general statutes is
139 repealed and the following is substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective from*
140 *passage*):

141 (b) Sections 30-9 to 30-13a, inclusive, section 30-22aa, subdivision ~~[(2)]~~

142 (3) of subsection (b) [of section 30-39,] and subsection (c) of section 30-
 143 39, as amended by this act, and sections 30-44, 30-46, 30-48a and 30-91a
 144 shall not apply to a cafe permit issued pursuant to subsection (d) of
 145 section 30-22a.

146 Sec. 4. Subsection (b) of section 30-39 of the 2026 supplement to the
 147 general statutes is repealed and the following is substituted in lieu
 148 thereof (*Effective July 1, 2026*):

149 (b) (1) Any person desiring a liquor permit or a renewal of such a
 150 permit shall make an affirmed application therefor to the Department of
 151 Consumer Protection, upon forms to be furnished by the department,
 152 showing the name and address of the applicant and of the applicant's
 153 backer, if any, the location of the club or place of business which is to be
 154 operated under such permit and a financial statement setting forth all
 155 elements and details of any business transactions connected with the
 156 application. [Such] If such application is for a liquor permit that allows
 157 on-premises serving or consumption of alcoholic liquor, such
 158 application shall also include a detailed description of the type of live
 159 entertainment that is to be provided. A club or place of business shall be
 160 exempt from providing such detailed description if the club or place of
 161 business (A) was issued a liquor permit prior to October 1, 1993, and (B)
 162 has not altered the type of entertainment provided. The application shall
 163 also indicate any crimes of which the applicant or the applicant's backer
 164 may have been convicted. The department shall not review an initial
 165 application until the applicant has submitted all documents necessary
 166 to establish that state and local building, fire and zoning requirements
 167 and local ordinances concerning hours and days of sale will be met,
 168 except that local building and zoning requirements and local ordinances
 169 concerning hours and days of sale shall not apply to a cafe permit issued
 170 under subsection (d) or (h) of section 30-22a. If the applicant does not
 171 submit all such documents within the thirty-day period beginning on
 172 the date on which the department receives the initial application, or if
 173 such documents are not fully executed by the appropriate authorities,
 174 such initial application shall be deemed withdrawn and invalid. The

175 State Fire Marshal or the marshal's certified designee shall be
176 responsible for approving compliance with the State Fire Code at
177 Bradley International Airport. Any person desiring a permit provided
178 for in section 30-33b shall file a copy of such person's license with such
179 application if such license was issued by the Department of Consumer
180 Protection. The department may, at its discretion, conduct an
181 investigation to determine (i) whether a permit shall be issued to an
182 applicant or the applicant's backer, or (ii) the suitability of the proposed
183 permit premises. Completion of an inspection pursuant to subsection (f)
184 of section 29-305 shall not be deemed to constitute a precondition to
185 renewal of a permit that is subject to subsection (f) of section 29-305.

186 (2) The applicant shall pay to the department a nonrefundable
187 application fee, which fee shall be in addition to the fees prescribed in
188 this chapter for the permit sought. An application fee shall not be
189 charged for an application to renew a permit. The application fee shall
190 be in the amount of ten dollars for the filing of each application for a
191 permit by a nonprofit golf tournament permit under section 30-37g or a
192 temporary liquor permit for a noncommercial entity under section 30-
193 35; and in the amount of one hundred dollars for the filing of an initial
194 application for all other permits. Any permit issued shall be valid only
195 for the purposes and activities described in the application.

196 (3) (A) The applicant shall affix, and maintain in a legible condition
197 upon the outer door of the building wherein such place of business is to
198 be located and clearly visible from the public highway, the placard
199 provided by the department, not later than the day following the receipt
200 of the placard by the applicant. If such outer door of such premises is so
201 far from the public highway that such placard is not clearly visible as
202 provided, the department shall direct a suitable method to notify the
203 public of such application. When an application is filed for any type of
204 permit for a building that has not been constructed, such applicant shall
205 erect and maintain in a legible condition a sign not less than six feet by
206 four feet upon the site where such place of business is to be located,
207 instead of such placard upon the outer door of the building. The sign

208 shall set forth the type of permit applied for and the name of the
 209 proposed permittee, shall be clearly visible from the public highway and
 210 shall be so erected not later than the day following the receipt of the
 211 placard. Such applicant shall make a return to the department, under
 212 oath, of compliance with the foregoing requirements, in such form as
 213 the department may determine, but the department may require any
 214 additional proof of such compliance. Upon receipt of evidence of such
 215 compliance, the department may hold a hearing as to the suitability of
 216 the proposed location.

217 (B) The provisions of subparagraph (A) of this subdivision regarding
 218 placarding shall not apply to applications for [(A)] (i) airline permits
 219 issued under section 30-28a, [(B)] (ii) temporary liquor permits for
 220 noncommercial entities issued under section 30-35, [(C)] (iii) concession
 221 permits issued under section 30-33, [(D)] (iv) military permits issued
 222 under section 30-34, [(E)] (v) cafe permits issued under subsection (h) of
 223 section 30-22a, [(F)] (vi) warehouse permits issued under section 30-32,
 224 [(G)] (vii) broker's permits issued under section 30-30, [(H)] (viii) out-of-
 225 state shipper's permits for alcoholic liquor issued under section 30-18,
 226 as amended by this act, [(I)] (ix) out-of-state shipper's permits for beer
 227 issued under section 30-19, [(J)] (x) coliseum permits issued under
 228 section 30-33a, [(K)] (xi) nonprofit golf tournament permits issued under
 229 section 30-37g, [(L)] (xii) Connecticut craft cafe permits issued under
 230 section 30-22d to permittees who held a manufacturer permit for a brew
 231 pub or a manufacturer permit for beer issued under subsection (b) of
 232 section 30-16 and a brew pub before July 1, 2020, [(M)] (xiii) off-site farm
 233 winery sales and wine, cider and mead tasting permits issued under
 234 section 30-16a, [(N)] (xiv) out-of-state retailer shipper's permits for wine
 235 issued under section 30-18a, as amended by this act, [(O)] (xv) out-of-
 236 state winery shipper's permits for wine issued under section 30-18a, as
 237 amended by this act, [(P)] (xvi) in-state transporter permits for alcoholic
 238 liquor issued under section 30-19f, including, but not limited to, boats
 239 operating under such permits, [(Q)] (xvii) seasonal outdoor open-air
 240 permits issued under section 30-22e, [(R)] (xviii) festival permits issued

241 under section 30-37t, [(S)] (xix) temporary auction permits issued under
 242 section 30-37u, [(T)] (xx) outdoor open-air permits issued under section
 243 30-22f, and [(U)] (xxi) renewals of any permit described in
 244 subparagraphs [(A)] (B)(i) to [(T)] (B)(xx), inclusive, of this subdivision,
 245 if applicable. [The]

246 (C) Notwithstanding the provisions of subparagraph (B) of this
 247 subdivision, the provisions of subparagraph (A) of this subdivision
 248 regarding [placard display] placarding shall [also be required of] apply
 249 to any applicant who seeks to amend the type of live entertainment to
 250 be provided, either upon filing of a renewal application or upon
 251 requesting permission of the department in a form that requires the
 252 approval of the municipal zoning official.

253 (4) In any case in which a permit has been issued to a partnership, if
 254 one or more of the partners dies or retires, the remaining partner or
 255 partners need not file a new application for the unexpired portion of the
 256 current permit, and no additional fee for such unexpired portion shall
 257 be required. Notice of any such change shall be given to the department
 258 and the permit shall be endorsed to show correct ownership. When any
 259 partnership changes by reason of the addition of one or more persons, a
 260 new application with new fees shall be required.

261 Sec. 5. Section 30-45 of the 2026 supplement to the general statutes is
 262 repealed and the following is substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective from*
 263 *passage*):

264 [The] (a) Except as provided in subsection (b) of this section, the
 265 Department of Consumer Protection shall refuse [permits] any permit
 266 for the sale of alcoholic liquor to: [the following persons:] (1) Any state
 267 marshal, judicial marshal, judge of any court, prosecuting officer or
 268 member of any police force; (2) [any minor; (3)] any constable who (A)
 269 performs criminal law enforcement duties and is considered a peace
 270 officer by town ordinance pursuant to the provisions of subsection (a)
 271 of section 54-1f, or (B) is certified under the provisions of sections 7-294a

272 to 7-294e, inclusive, and performs criminal law enforcement duties
 273 pursuant to the provisions of subsection (c) of section 54-1f; [and (4)] (3)
 274 any special constable appointed pursuant to section 7-92; [. This] and (4)
 275 any minor as the permittee or as a member, principal or partner of the
 276 backer, provided nothing in this subdivision shall be construed to
 277 require the department to refuse any such permit to a trust with a named
 278 beneficiary who is a minor.

279 (b) The provisions of subdivisions (1) to (3), inclusive, of subsection
 280 (a) of this section shall not apply to: [any] (1) Any out-of-state shipper's
 281 permit issued under section 30-18, as amended by this act, 30-18a, as
 282 amended by this act, or 30-19; [,] (2) any cafe permit issued under section
 283 30-22a; [,] (3) any cafe permit for wine, beer and cider issued under
 284 section 30-22g; [,] (4) any boat operating under any in-state transporter
 285 permit issued under section 30-19f; or (5) any airline permit issued
 286 under section 30-28a. [As used in this section, "minor" means a minor,
 287 as defined in section 1-1d or as defined in section 30-1, whichever age is
 288 older.]

289 Sec. 6. Section 30-86a of the general statutes is repealed and the
 290 following is substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective from passage*):

291 (a) For the purposes of section 30-86, any permittee shall require any
 292 person whose age is in question to fill out and sign a statement in the
 293 following form on one occasion when each such person makes a
 294 purchase:

295 ..., 20..

296 I, ..., hereby represent to ..., a permittee of the Connecticut
 297 Department of Consumer Protection, that I am over the age of 21 years,
 298 having been born on ..., 19.. or 20.., at (city), (state). This
 299 statement is made to induce said permittee to sell or otherwise furnish
 300 alcoholic beverages to the undersigned. I understand that title 30 of the
 301 general statutes prohibits the sale of alcoholic liquor to any person who
 302 is not twenty-one years of age.

303 I understand that I am subject to a fine of one hundred dollars for the
304 first offense and not more than two hundred fifty dollars for each
305 subsequent offense for wilfully misrepresenting my age for the
306 purposes set forth in this statement.

307 (Name)

308 (Address)

309 Such statement once taken shall be applicable both to the particular
310 sale in connection with which such statement was taken, as well as to all
311 future sales at the same premises, and shall have full force and effect
312 under subsection (b) of this section as to every subsequent sale or
313 purchase. Such statement shall be printed upon appropriate forms to be
314 furnished by the permittee and approved by the Department of
315 Consumer Protection or electronically displayed by the permittee on an
316 electronic device that is capable of allowing the person whose age is in
317 question to electronically fill out and sign such statement. If such
318 statement is filled out and signed in paper form, such statement shall be
319 kept on file on the permit premises, alphabetically indexed, in a suitable
320 file box, and shall be open to inspection by the department or any of the
321 department's agents or inspectors at any reasonable time. If such
322 statement is filled out and signed in electronic form, such statement
323 shall be stored in an electronic medium that is immediately accessible
324 from the permit premises, alphabetically indexed, and shall be in an
325 electronic format that is accessible to the department or any of the
326 department's agents or inspectors at any reasonable time. Any person
327 who makes any false statement on a form signed by such person as
328 required by this section shall be fined not more than one hundred
329 dollars for the first offense and not more than two hundred fifty dollars
330 for each subsequent offense.

331 (b) In any case where such a statement has been procured and the
332 permittee is subsequently charged with serving or furnishing alcoholic
333 beverages to a minor, if such permittee, in proceedings before any court

334 of this state or the Department of Consumer Protection, introduces such
 335 statement in evidence and shows both that the evidence presented to
 336 [him] such permittee to establish the age of the purchaser was such as
 337 would convince a reasonable [man] person, and that such permittee or
 338 the backer otherwise acted reasonably in serving or furnishing alcoholic
 339 beverages to the minor, no penalty shall be imposed on such permittee.

This act shall take effect as follows and shall amend the following sections:

Section 1	<i>from passage</i>	30-18(b)
Sec. 2	<i>from passage</i>	30-18a
Sec. 3	<i>from passage</i>	30-37f(b)
Sec. 4	<i>July 1, 2026</i>	30-39(b)
Sec. 5	<i>from passage</i>	30-45
Sec. 6	<i>from passage</i>	30-86a

Statement of Purpose:

To (1) eliminate a requirement that certain out-of-state shipper permittees report to the Department of Consumer Protection records concerning sales and shipments to consumers in this state, (2) define "retailer" for purposes of certain out-of-state shippers' permits concerning wine, (3) specify that applicants for issuance or renewal of a liquor permit that allows on-premises serving or consumption of alcoholic liquor must disclose to the department a detailed description of the type of live entertainment to be provided, (4) specify that the department shall refuse any liquor permit to a minor as the permittee or as a member, principal or partner of the backer, unless such permit is for a trust with a named beneficiary who is a minor, (5) alter the evidentiary burden applicable to a permittee who is charged with serving or furnishing an alcoholic beverage to a minor, and (6) make various technical and conforming changes to the statutes concerning liquor control.

[Proposed deletions are enclosed in brackets. Proposed additions are indicated by underline, except that when the entire text of a bill or resolution or a section of a bill or resolution is new, it is not underlined.]